Phishing Awareness Training



Recognize. Resist. Report.

CodeAlpha Cyber Security Internship | Task 2

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Types of phishing attacks

Same goal (steal credentials, money or access), different channels.

EM

Email phishing

Mass emails posing as banks, shops or services.

SP

Spear phishing

Personalized message aimed at one person or team.

WH

Whaling

Targets executives to approve payments or share data.

SM

Smishing

Fake text messages with urgent links.

VI

Vishing

Phone calls from fake support or banks.

QR

Quishing

Malicious QR codes leading to fake sites.

Spot the phishing email

1. From: support@paypa1-secure.com
2. Subject: URGENT - account suspended!
3. Dear Customer,
4. Verify within 24 hours or your account will be closed.

   Verify Now

5. Attachment: invoice_8841.zip

Red flags

1. **Fake sender domain**
   paypa1, not paypal
2. **Urgency and threats**
   pressure to act fast
3. **Generic greeting**
   no name, no details
4. **Suspicious link**
   hover to see the real URL
5. **Unexpected attachment**
   never open unknown files

Spot the fake website

Real	Fake	The trick
paypal.com	paypa1.com	Digit "1" replaces the letter "l"
microsoft.com	microsoft.com.secure-login.xyz	Real domain is secure-login.xyz
amazon.com	amazon-support.net	Brand name plus extra words
google.com	gooogle.com	One extra letter in the name

The padlock (HTTPS) only means the connection is encrypted, not that the site is honest. Type the address yourself or use a bookmark.

How attackers manipulate you

1. **Urgency**
   "Act within 24 hours or your account closes."
2. **Authority**
   "This is the CEO. Buy gift cards now."
3. **Fear**
   "Suspicious login detected on your account."
4. **Curiosity and greed**
   "You won a prize! Click to claim it."
5. **Trust**
   A message that looks like it comes from a colleague.
6. **Helpfulness**
   "IT support" asks for your password to help.

Real-world phishing attacks

2016

Fake Google alert

A spear-phishing email faked a Google security warning. A campaign chairman entered his password and thousands of emails leaked.

Lesson: Go to the site yourself, never through the email link.

2020

Calls to IT staff

Attackers phoned employees posing as IT support, gained internal access and hijacked well-known social media accounts.

Lesson: Verify callers through an official number.

2013-15

Fake invoices

A scammer posing as a supplier sent fake invoices and received over $100 million from two big tech companies.

Lesson: Confirm payment changes on a second channel.

Stay safe: best practices

Do this every day

- Check the sender address and hover over links
- Never share passwords, codes or PINs
- Turn on multi-factor authentication (MFA)
- Use a password manager and unique passwords
- Keep devices and browsers updated
- Report suspicious messages to IT or security

If you clicked

1. Change your password
2. Turn on MFA
3. Report it immediately
4. Scan your device
5. Monitor your accounts

Test yourself: open quiz.html in the Task 2 folder and try the 8-question quiz.